

Joana Pina · she/her

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PROFILE

My background is in industrial engineering and management, but the last three years pulled me toward people, products, and growth. I **co-founded a startup and grew it to 5,000 users in under four months**, owning the product and the experience. Alongside an MBA and consulting work, I moved into AI, where I run discovery and design solutions for clients across sectors, then work with the developers who build them. I am **obsessed with making complex things simple**.

Key interests: Customer experience · Product & Project management · Discovery & solution design · Applied AI

EXPERIENCE

AI Transformation Consultant

Dec 2025 to Present

Upgraiide Artificial Intelligence

- Run discovery and solution design for three client companies across sectors: map how each business works, find where AI can take work off people, and design the AI solution with the developer for a clean hand-off.
- Build demos and prototypes of each solution, for example a web-app demo for a finance team.
- Build the ROI and payback business case for every engagement, with the quantitative and qualitative benefits.
- With the founders, used AI to optimize the company's marketing, from post creation to analytics.

Co-Founder

Feb 2025 to Nov 2025

RewU

- Co-founded a rewards-for-attention platform and ran with it: the strategy, the go-to-market, and the partnerships.
- Owned the product end to end: the brand, the experience, and the full prototype, with the developer kept aligned to it.
- Grew the platform to 5,000 users and 50 partner companies in under four months.

Consultant

Aug 2023 to Aug 2024

Kaizen Institute

- Led workshops and applied Lean tools (5S, Ishikawa, root-cause analysis) to drive continuous improvement.
- Co-developed and implemented three improvement projects, lifting process efficiency by up to 30%.
- Delivered six Value Stream Analyses in a year, contributing over €1M in EBITDA impact.

Master's Thesis Intern

Feb 2023 to Jul 2023

Confidencial Imobiliário

- Conducted a Master's thesis on environmental, social and corporate-governance (ESG) factors in Portuguese real-estate pricing, using statistical tools and visualization to measure the impact.

Process Improvement Intern

Feb 2021 to Jul 2021

Coindu

- Improved process quality and optimized group roadmaps by applying lean manufacturing principles.

EDUCATION

International MBA

Sep 2024 to Oct 2025

Porto Business School, University of Porto · Exchange at Sasin, Thailand (2025)

- Final Consulting Project for Natixis: designed a standardized onboarding and learning path for new credit-risk analysts, endorsed by senior leadership for implementation.
- Focus: Strategy, Innovation & Digital Strategy, Business Analytics, Communicating with Impact.

BSc & MSc, Industrial Engineering & Management

Sep 2018 to Jul 2023

FEUP, University of Porto · Erasmus at KIT, Germany (2021 to 2022)

- Focus: Problem solving, Business analytics, Strategic thinking.

SKILLS

Product: Product discovery · Product vision · UX/UI prototyping · Roadmapping

AI & Solutions: GenAI / LLM solution design · Use-case identification · ROI & payback cases

Delivery: Stakeholder management · Cross-functional collaboration · Project management

LANGUAGES

Portuguese (Native) · English (C1) · Spanish (A2) · German (A1)